Nia Rebekah Mucher

AI Evaluation · Education Technology
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Education

University of Virginia, *B.A., Computer Science & History | GPA 3.86* — Expected May 2027

Northern Virginia Community College, *A.S., Computer Science | GPA 3.91* — Sep 2023 – May 2025

Honors & Awards

- Undergraduate Researcher Award, UVA Department of Computer Science; selected annually by faculty • 2026
- Robert Kent Gooch Scholarship, UVA Arts & Sciences; for the mind and character of Rhodes Scholars • 2026
- Kenan Award ($5,000), UVA Office of Citizen Scholar Development • 2026

Publications

- Mucher, N., Pham, N., Chin, J., Brown, A., Evans, D. *Proxy Based Method for Measuring Disparities in Image Generators*. 9th AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society(AIES 2026), Malmö, Sweden.
  Oral Presentation
- Mucher, N. *Rendering the Invisible: Digital and Oral Interpretation of Difficult History at the University of Virginia's Anatomical Theatre*. International Conference on Cognition and Exploratory Learning in the Digital Age (CELDA 2026), Lisbon, Portugal.

Select Research Experience

Research Assistant, AI Bias & Education, *UVA Engineering, advised by Prof. David Evans* — Jan 2026 – Present

- Developed a proxy-based method for measuring racial disparities in AI image generators; first-author paper accepted as an oral presentation at AIES 2026.
- Grounded the method in anti-discrimination law and schools' constitutional duties with law students; it measures disparities without racial balancing.
- Briefed Albemarle County Public Schools officials, informing its digital citizenship curriculum, and Lisa Gelobter, NYC CTO; partnered with Canva and Stanford's AI Tinkery to promote adoption.

Principal Investigator, AR & Public History, *UVA, mentored by Prof. Louis Nelson* — May 2026 – Present

- Lead IRB-approved research on augmented reality for public engagement with historic sites; authored paper on digital interpretation of UVA's Anatomical Theatre (CELDA 2026).

Technical Researcher, Virginia AI Security Initiative, *UVA* — Fall 2025 – Present

- Replicated and extended Anthropic's emotion-vector interpretability methodology on Gemma 2 2B.

Research Intern, Digital Transmedia, *Barnard Theatre, advised by Prof. Hana Worthen* — Sep 2021 – May 2022

- Prototyped an interactive historical graphic novel using NYPL records about the circus elephant Jumbo.

Select Professional & Leadership Experience

Vice President (incoming President), Virginia AI Security Initiative, *UVA* — May 2026 – Present

- Lead the 50+ member organization's policy fellowship: two cohorts of 18, meeting two hours weekly; Mentor members one-on-one on research and careers.

Student Technology Council, *University of Virginia* — Fall 2026 – Present

- Student lead on UVA's strategic AI research plan with Ryan Wright, Special Advisor to the Provost for AI Research; author reports on AI use in higher education.

Education Technology Intern, *mEducation Alliance* — Jan – May 2026

- Assessed mobile STEM kits in 20+ countries through interviews with Ministries of Education and NGOs.

Technology Innovation Intern, *National Museum of African American History and Culture* — Jun – Aug 2025

- Authored white papers on AI regulation in cultural institutions; briefed senior executives.

Substitute Teacher, *Fairfax County Public Schools* — Dec 2024 – Dec 2025

- Taught English Language Learners and students with disabilities using assistive and digital tools.

Professional Service: Program Committee Member, AIES '26 • Invited Panelist, K-12 Coalition Think Tank, '26

Volunteer: Mentor, Computers for Kids • Photographer, Jefferson School African American Heritage Center